

**NCERT QUESTIONS WITH SOLUTIONS**

1. Choose the right answer from the four alternatives given below:

(i) In which of the following States is the Wular Lake located?

- (1) Rajasthan
- (2) Uttar Pradesh
- (3) Punjab
- (4) Jammu and Kashmir

Ans. (4) Jammu and Kashmir

(ii) The river Narmada has its source at:

- (1) Satpura
- (2) Brahmagir
- (3) Amarkantak
- (4) Slopes of the Western Ghats

Ans. (3) Amarkantak

(iii) Which one of the following lakes is a salt water lake?

- (1) Sambhar
- (2) Dal
- (3) Wular
- (4) Gobind Sagar

Ans. (1) Sambhar

(iv) Which one of the following is the longest river of the Peninsular India?

- (1) Narmada
- (2) Krishna
- (3) Godavari
- (4) Mahanadi

Ans. (3) Godavari

(v) Which among the following rivers flows through a rift valley?

- (1) Damodar
- (2) Tungabhadra
- (3) Krishna
- (4) Tapi

Ans. (4) Tapi

2. Answer the following questions briefly.

(i) What is meant by a water divide? Give an example.

Ans. Any elevated area such as a mountain or an upland that separates two drainage basins is called a water divide. An example of water divide is the Western Ghats.

(ii) Which is the largest river basin in India?

Ans. The Ganga river basin is the largest river basin in India.

(iii) Where do the rivers Indus and Ganga have their origin?

Ans. Indus rises in Tibet near Lake Mansarowar. Ganga has Bhagirathi as the head water which is fed by the Gangotri glacier.

(iv) Name two headstreams of the Ganga. Where do they meet to form the Ganga?

Ans. The two headstreams of the Ganga are the Alaknanda and the Bhagirathi and they both meet to form the Ganga at Devaprayag.

(v) Why does Brahmaputra in the Tibetan part have less silt despite a longer course?

Ans. Called river Tsang Po in Tibet, Brahmaputra has very little volume of water. So it obviously carries little silt. But once it enters India, Brahmaputra is fed by heavy rains, and it carries lot of water and silt.

(vi) Which two peninsular rivers flow through troughs? What features do they form while entering the sea?

Ans. The two rivers that flow through troughs are Narmada and Tapi. They form estuaries while entering the sea.



NCERT Basics : Class 9

(vii) Give five economic benefits of rivers and lakes.

Ans. Role of rivers in the economy:

- (a) Rivers create alluvial soils.
- (b) River irrigation is the backbone of agriculture in areas that have insufficient rainfall.
- (c) Many industrial processes depend on river water as a coolant and for generation of hydroelectricity.
- (d) Rivers provide inland channels for transport.
- (e) Rivers provide fisheries, scope for developing adventure sports like rafting and entertainment joints. Lakes like the Sambhar Lake provide edible salt. They also help develop tourism and provide recreation.

3. Below are given names of a few lakes of India. Group those under two categories- natural and created by human beings.

- (a) Wular
- (b) Dal
- (c) Nainital
- (d) Bhimtal
- (e) Gobind Sagar
- (f) Loktak
- (g) Barapani
- (h) Chilika
- (i) Sambhar
- (j) Rana Pratap Sagar
- (k) Nizam Sagar
- (l) Pulicat
- (m) Nagarjuna Sagar
- (n) Hirakud

Ans. Natural Lakes: Wular, Dal, Nainital, Bhimtal, Chilika, Pulicat, Sambhar, Barapani, Loktak

Created by human beings: Gobind Sagar, Hirakud, Rana Pratap Sagar, Nagarjuna Sagar, Nizam Sagar

4. Discuss the significant differences between the Himalayan and the Peninsular rivers.

Ans. The Indian rivers are divided into two major groups:

- (a) The Himalayan rivers and
- (b) The Peninsular rivers.

Points of difference:

- (a) The Himalayan rivers mostly originate in the Himalayan ranges whereas the Peninsular rivers mostly originate in the Western Ghats.
- (b) The Himalayan rivers are perennial whereas the Peninsular rivers are seasonal
- (c) The Peninsular rivers have shorter and shallower courses in comparison to the Himalayan rivers.

5. Compare the east-flowing and the west-flowing rivers of the Peninsular Plateau.

OR

Why are the rivers of Peninsula seasonal? Give two differences between the west-flowing and east-flowing rivers of Peninsular Plateau.

Ans. The major rivers of the peninsular are the Mahanadi, the Godavari, the Krishna etc. are flowing eastward and merges into the Bay of Bengal. Only the river Narmada and Tapi are flowing towards west and merge into the Arabian Sea. The essential differences between the two rivers are as follows:

**East flowing Rivers**

- (a) The east-flowing rivers have deltas at their mouth.
- (b) All rivers east flowing drain into the Bay of Bengal.
- (c) All these rivers passed through a varied topography, i.e. hills, plains, plateaus etc.
- (d) Most rivers are fed by many east-west-flowing long tributaries.

West flowing Rivers

- (a) The west flowing rivers do not have deltas at their mouth. They form estuaries.
- (b) All west flowing rivers merge into the Arabian Sea.
- (c) These rivers are flowed through the rift valley.
- (d) A few small tributaries joining at right angles are only found.

6. Why are rivers important for the country's economy?

Ans. Rivers are the lifelines of a nation. Rivers have been of fundamental importance in the settlement and progress of man throughout the human history. The rivers form broad, fertile alluvial plains that have been the cradle of human civilisation. Water from the river is a basic natural resource, essential for various human activities. They provide water for domestic use. Rivers provide

water for irrigation that helps to develop agriculture in the surrounding area. The fertile soil of the riverine plain, abundant supply of water and the flat land provides opportunities for the development of agriculture. In an agricultural country like India, rivers play a major role in shaping the country's economy. Rivers supply water for industrial use. Rivers provide for a cheap mode of transportation, inland navigation. Hydro-electricity harnessed from river water supplies power to our industries, to our homes and to our agricultural fields. Integrated water management of rivers through River Valley Projects by building dams provide hydro-electricity, water for irrigation, inland navigation, fishing, recreation etc. Hence, rivers are of great importance in the flourishing of a country's economy.

MAP SKILLS

On an outline map of India show the following.

- (i) On an outline map of India mark and label the following rivers : Ganga, Satluj, Damodar, Krishna, Narmada, Tapi, Mahanadi, and Brahmaputra.
- (ii) On an outline map of India mark and label the following lakes : Chilika, Sambhar, Wular, Pulicat, Kolleru.



**EXERCISE-01****Multiple choice questions**

1. What is an area drained by a single river system called? **SDR038**
(1) Drainage basin (2) Water divide
(3) Water Zone (4) Doab
2. Most of the Himalayan rivers are: - **SDR039**
(1) Seasonal
(2) Perennial
(3) Both (1) and (2)
(4) None of these
3. The Vembanad Lake is located in **SDR040**
(1) Kerala
(2) Andhra Pradesh
(3) Tamil Nadu
(4) Odisha
4. What is an upland that separates two drainage basins known as? **SDR041**
(1) Drainage basin
(2) Drainage system
(3) Water divide
(4) River system
5. Meanders are formed in which one of the following courses of a river. **SDR042**
(1) Upper course
(2) At the mouth of river
(3) Lower course
(4) Middle course
6. Which one of the following peninsular rivers is called the 'Dakshin Ganga'? **SDR043**
(1) Mahanadi (2) Krishna
(3) Godavari (4) Tapi
7. The river Indus originates in: **SDR044**
(1) Nepal (2) Bhutan
(3) Tibet (4) Bangladesh
8. Alaknanda and Bhagirathi converge to be called as Ganga at: **SDR045**
(1) Haridwar (2) Kedarnath
(3) Badrinath (4) Devaprayag
9. Which one of the following is a peninsular tributary of the Ganga? **SDR046**
(1) Ghaggar (2) Son
(3) Gomti (4) Gandak
10. Which one of the following rivers has the largest drainage basin in India? **SDR047**
(1) The Indus (2) The Ganga
(3) The Brahmaputra (4) The Mahanadi
11. The Brahmaputra (Tsang Po) river rises in: **SDR048**
(1) Sikkim (2) Tibet
(3) Bhutan (4) Nepal
12. Which one of the following statements about the river Narmada is not true? **SDR049**
(1) It flows through a rift valley
(2) It flows through a gorge near Jabalpur
(3) It plunges over steep rocks at the Dhuadhar falls
(4) Its tributaries are Tungabhadra and Musi
13. Which of the following rivers rises in the highlands of Chhattisgarh? **SDR050**
(1) Mahanadi (2) Godavari
(3) Chambal (4) Damodar
14. The Wainganga and the Penganga are tributaries of which of the following rivers? **SDR051**
(1) The Mahanadi (2) The Narmada
(3) The Godavari (4) The Krishna
15. Which of the following is not a tributary of river Krishna? **SDR052**
(1) Tungabhadra (2) Koyna
(3) Wardha (4) Bhima
16. Which type of lakes contain water only during the rainy season? **SDR053**
(1) Oxbow lakes
(2) Lagoons
(3) Lakes in basins of inland drainage
(4) Glacial lakes



NCERT Basics : Class 9

17. Which is the largest freshwater lake in India? **SDR054**

- (1) Wular Lake (2) Dal Lake
(3) Bhimtal (4) Nainital

18. In which of the following states is Sambhar Lake situated? **SDR055**

- (1) Rajasthan
(2) Uttar Pradesh
(3) Bihar
(4) Jammu and Kashmir

19. Why have the river banks attracted settlers from ancient times? **SDR056**

- (1) Water is a basic natural resource
(2) Rivers provide water for irrigation
(3) Rivers provide facilities for inland navigation
(4) All the above

20. Which of the following is not one of the causes of river pollution? **SDR057**

- (1) Dumping of garbage
(2) Aquatic organisms and algae
(3) Discharge of untreated sewage
(4) Discharge of industrial effluents

True or false

1. The area drained by a single river system is called drainage basin. **SDR058**

2. In their middle and lower course, the Himalayan rivers form meanders, oxbow lakes, and many other depositional features in their floodplains. **SDR059**

3. The Sutlej, the Beas, the Ravi, the Chenab, and the Jhelum join together to enter the Indus near Karachi in Pakistan. **SDR060**

4. Brahmaputra is slightly longer than the Indus, and most of its course lies outside India. **SDR061**

5. Godavari basin covers parts of Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, and Maharashtra. **SDR062**

Fill in the blanks

1. Most of the Himalayan rivers are _____. It means that they have water throughout the year. **SDR063**

2. A large number of Peninsular rivers are seasonal, as their flow is dependent on _____. **SDR064**

3. Yamuna flows parallel to the Ganga, as a right bank tributary, meets the Ganga at _____. **SDR065**

4. The Narmada and Tapi are the only long rivers, which flow west and make _____. **SDR066**

5. Mahanadi rises in the highlands of _____. It flows through Odisha to reach the Bay of Bengal. **SDR067**

Match the columns

SDR068

1.	Column I	Column II
(A)	Indus	(i) rises from a spring near ahabaleshwar
(B)	Brahma putra	(ii) rises in the Amarkantak hills in Madhya Pradesh
(C)	Narmada	(iii) rises from the hores of the Western Ghats, in the Nashik district of Maharashtra
(D)	Godavari	(iv) rises in Tibet, east of Lake Mansarovar
(E)	Krishna	(v) rises in the Brahmagiri range of the Western Ghats
(F)	Kaveri	(vi) rises in Tibet, near Lake Mansarovar

**ANSWER KEY****Multiple choice questions**

Question	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Answer	1	2	1	3	3	3	3	4	2	2	2	4	1	3	3
Question	16	17	18	19	20										
Answer	3	1	1	4	2										

True or false

1. True
2. True
3. False
4. True
5. False

Fill in the blanks

1. Perennial
2. rainfall
3. Allahabad
4. estuaries
5. Chhattisgarh

Match the column

1. (A) → (vi) ; (B) → (iv) ; (C) → (ii) ; (D) → (iii) ; (E) → (i) ; (F) → (v)



EXERCISE-02

Short Answer Type Questions

1. What are perennial and non-perennial rivers? Give reasons why the Himalayan region consists of perennial rivers. **SDR069**
2. Why is the Godavari often referred to as the 'Dakshin Ganga'? Write a note on the river Godavari and its tributaries. **SDR070**
3. Write a note on the river Krishna and its tributaries. **SDR071**
4. Where are India's most of the freshwater lakes located and why? **SDR072**
5. Write a short note on river pollution. **SDR073**

Long Answer Type Questions

6. What are the differences between the Himalayan rivers and the Peninsular rivers? **SDR074**
7. Write a note on the Indus River System. **SDR075**
8. Write a note on the Brahmaputra River System. **SDR076**
9. Name any two major river systems of the Peninsular region. Describe any one in detail. **SDR077**
10. Why are rivers important for a country's economy? **SDR078**



